A Play Day with My Brother Ray

by Lucy Bledsoe
illustrated by Óscar T. Pérez

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Illustrations by Óscar T. Pérez
Book design by Raul Chacon

Center for the Collaborative Classroom
1250 53rd Street, Suite 3
Emeryville, CA 94608-2965
(800) 666-7270 ★ fax: (510) 464-3670
collaborativeclassroom.org

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Because there is no school, I can stay home with Ray. We are going to talk and play all day.

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"Talk and play all day?" Ray says. "No way.
We have to walk to the store."

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"Why do we need to walk to the store?" I ask.
"Because I need paint and nails," Ray says.

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"Why do you need paint and nails?" I ask.
"Because I am going to work on the fence,"
Ray says.

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"Why not take the train?" I say. "Walking is slow, like a snail. The subway is faster."

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"We are walking because we have just a short way to go," Ray says. "Come on, we can talk as we walk."

"The sky is gray! It may rain. Why can't we stay home and play?" I ask.

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"I can't play all day," says Ray, "because I have work to do. Come on, you can sit up here if you don't want to walk!"

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Ray walks. I talk.
"You like to talk a lot, don't you?" Ray asks.

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"Wait!" I yell. "Here comes the rain!"

"I have to paint today," Ray says. "I don't have time for rain."

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"You can't paint in the rain because the rain will wipe away the paint," I tell my big brother.

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"That's not rain," Ray says. "That's hail. Run!"

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"Yay!" I say. "We can talk and play for the rest of the day."

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